

Project Indiana Overview





What is Project Indiana?

verizon



An internal initiative crusade to whip-up awareness and centralize records of customer-facing issues.

The Mission

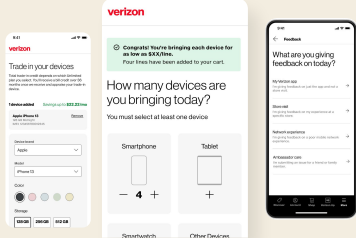
**Create awareness
of CX issues via
a unified dashboard**

The Goal

**Improved
CX excellence**

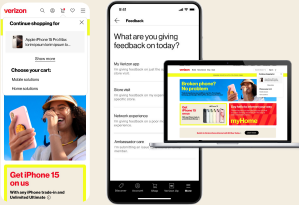
Broken customer-facing experiences risk damaging Verizon's customer loyalty and engagement.

We've seen examples of these issues get escalated by executive leadership:



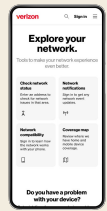
The image shows three screenshots of the Verizon trade-in interface. The first shows a 'Trade-in your device' screen with a dropdown for 'Device brand' set to 'Apple' and a 'Get credit' button. The second shows a confirmation screen: 'Congrats! You're bringing each device for as low as \$0.00. Your lines have been added to your cart. How many devices are you bringing today?' with buttons for 'Smartphone' and 'Tablet'. The third shows a 'Feedback' screen with the question 'What are you giving feedback on today?'.

 **Trade-in Without Credit**
A trade-in was made but never received credit



The image shows three screenshots of Verizon pricing. The first is a 'Continue shopping for' screen showing a 'Get iPhone 15 on US' offer. The second is a 'What are you giving feedback on today?' screen. The third is a 'Choose your cart' screen showing a 'Buy Now' button. The screenshots illustrate a pricing mismatch between the MVA and MVO platforms.

 **MVA/MVO Pricing Mismatch**
Differing pricing across MVA and MVO platforms



The image shows a screenshot of the Verizon 'Explore your network' page. It includes sections for 'Check network status', 'Network coverage', 'Network availability', and 'Coverage map'. To the right of the screenshot is a Wi-Fi signal icon.

 **Home Internet - Fios Outage**
Frustrating experience with Verizon FIOS network outages

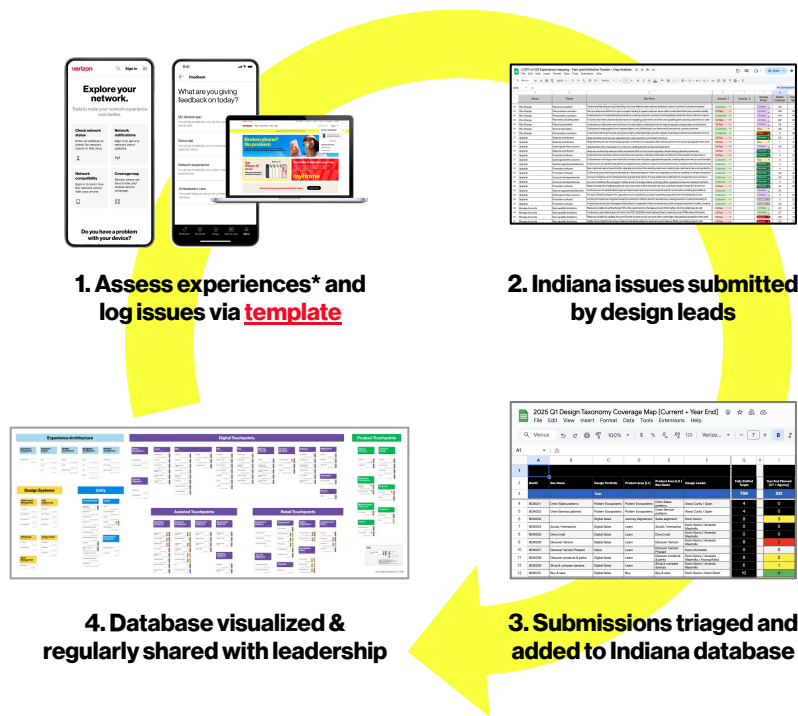
The Project Indiana approach

Creating an avenue to proactively raise awareness of issues in one place

CX teams need a way to document issues to in a **simple way** and **in a central place**.

In establishing a bottom-up escalation path, we are also shifting the burden off of executive leadership by providing teams with an avenue to make these issues known to a wider audience.

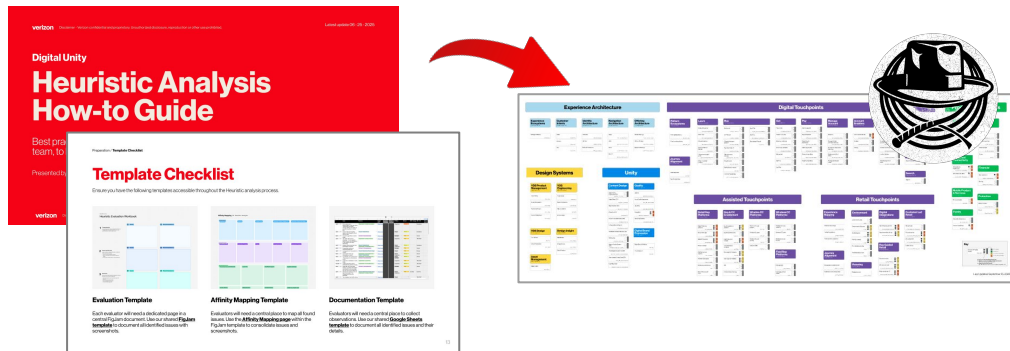
**Note: assessments could be VQA, heuristic assessments (see slide 7), CMI research, app store reviews, etc. - as long as it's in production.*



DU Heuristic Analysis Guidelines

Digital Unity is rolling out guidelines and templates to complete heuristic assessments in a consistent and streamlined way across all CX Design teams.

This will be crucial for **Project Indiana**, aiming to compile a database of our known customer-facing issues for improved awareness and operational efficiency.



Links

[Spreadsheet Template](#)

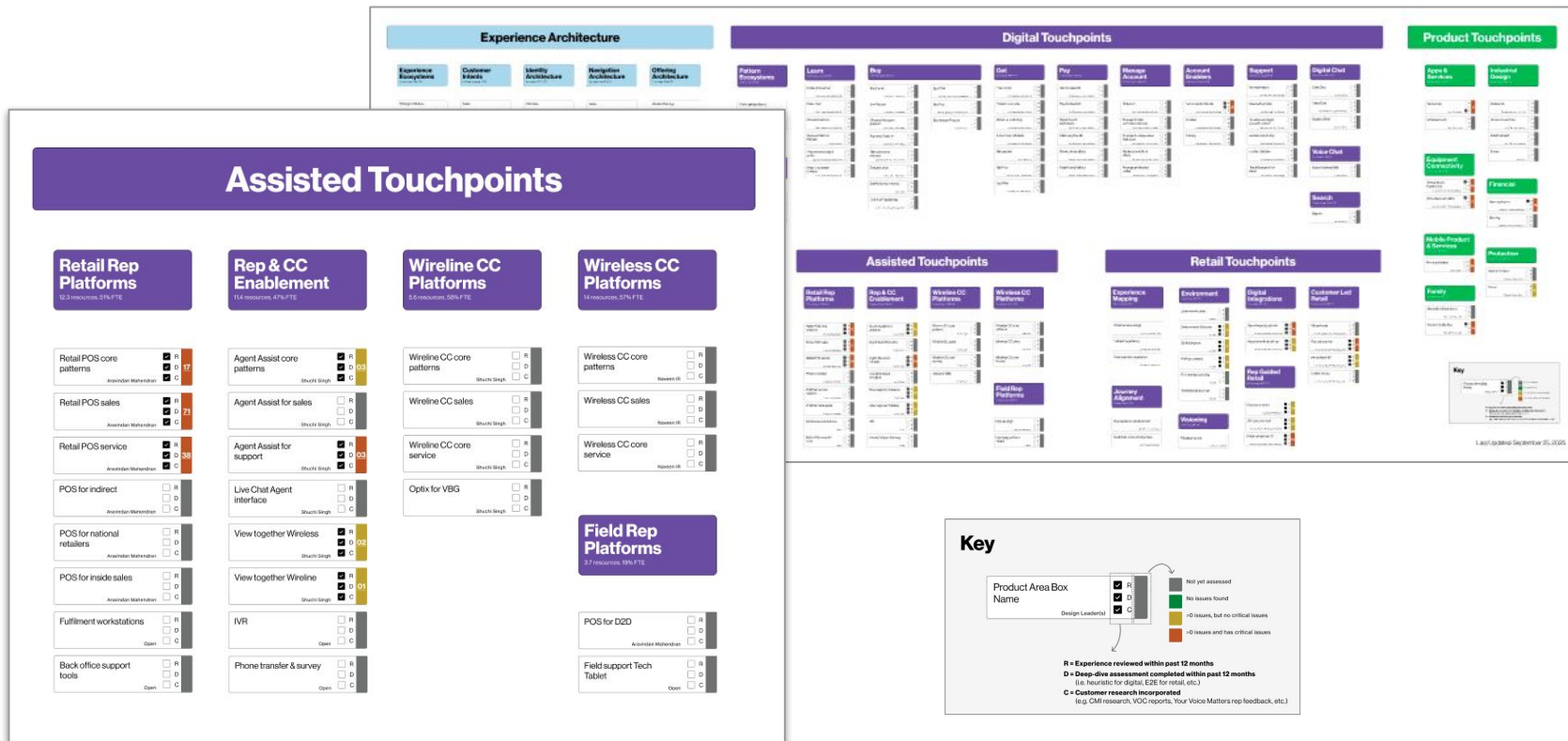
[Heuristic Analysis How-to](#)

- [Template Checklist](#)
- [Heuristic Analysis Output](#)

[Example](#)

[Quality of digital journeys presentation](#)

The Project Indiana dashboard



Key for reading design taxonomy boxes

Guidance for CXD teams

Project Indiana

2025 goal:

Each taxonomy box has completed some level of review by end of year.

Our ask:

Make it a priority with your team in Q4 to submit documentation of customer-facing issues*.

**This doesn't have to be a heuristic assessment output.*

Support available on request basis:

- Project Indiana overview presentation
- DU heuristic assessment overview presentation, templates, and guidance
- General guidance, brainstorming, moral support, etc.

**You have questions,
we have answers.**

**“What’s an
Indiana issue?”**



Guidelines for Project Indiana issues

Issues with Critical, High and Medium criticality are considered “Indiana issues”

Critical (S4)

Severe issues that compromise professionalism and brand representation. These issues may prevent the user from completing their task, and/or undermine the overall quality and visual integrity of the product.

High (S3)

Significant errors that severely impact quality of the experience. Users can complete the task, but with significant delay or frustration. This includes issues to visual quality, such as typos, clear text errors, or major visual deviations from the design.

Medium (S2)

Noticeable issues that affect the usability, overall appearance, and/or brand perception. The user will be able to navigate the experience, but may have to undertake some moderate effort in getting around the problem (i.e. friction).

Low (S1)

Issues that minimally impact quality of the experience.



See Digital Unity's [Quality presentation](#), slides 12-14, for more information.

Assessment Levels for reporting

Why is this important?

Understanding the “level” will help us have a better idea of **our confidence** in the number of issues being reported.

What are the assessment levels?

Level 1: Only members of the accountable design team conducted the assessment.

Level 2: Level 1 + additional data sources (e.g. partner teams’ backlogs/ lists, direct customer feedback, CMI reporting, etc.).

Level 3: Level 1 + Level 2 + in-depth assessment completed by a non-accountable design team within the past 6 months.

“How should I be assessing experiences, and how often?”

Digital Unity has published guidance on how to conduct assessments of our customer-facing experiences.

Heuristic assessments should be completed *at least every 6 months*. Ideally this should be relative to the rate of change of your area of customer-facing experience.

We also encourage completing visual QA in production after every release with experience changes.

Both heuristic and VQA issues should be logged for Project Indiana, as both are customer-facing issues.



See [Indiana x Heuristic Assessment overview](#) for more information

“What should we be submitting?”

Digital Unity has templates and guidance to support creating a list of customer-facing issues that can be used for Project Indiana.

The Indiana spreadsheet template should be used to capture issues in production.



See Digital Unity's [Quality presentation](#), slides 13-15, for more information.

“Are we expected to fix the Indiana issues we identify?”

Not as part of Project Indiana.

Project Indiana's mission is to **create awareness** of these customer-facing issues. The intended result of that awareness is that these issues will be prioritized and ultimately resolved.

However, **there is no explicit expectation as part of Project Indiana** that teams resolve these issues outside of their usual prioritization process with their business partners.

“We already have a list of issues in our backlog.”

Great! We want that list.

Backlogs or existing spreadsheets/ lists are a great place to start, and this project will just make sure there's greater visibility into those issues.

We especially want design leads to work with their CXO/ business/ engineering partners to consolidate customer-facing issues of their owned experiences; **this shouldn't be a siloed exercise owned by design.**

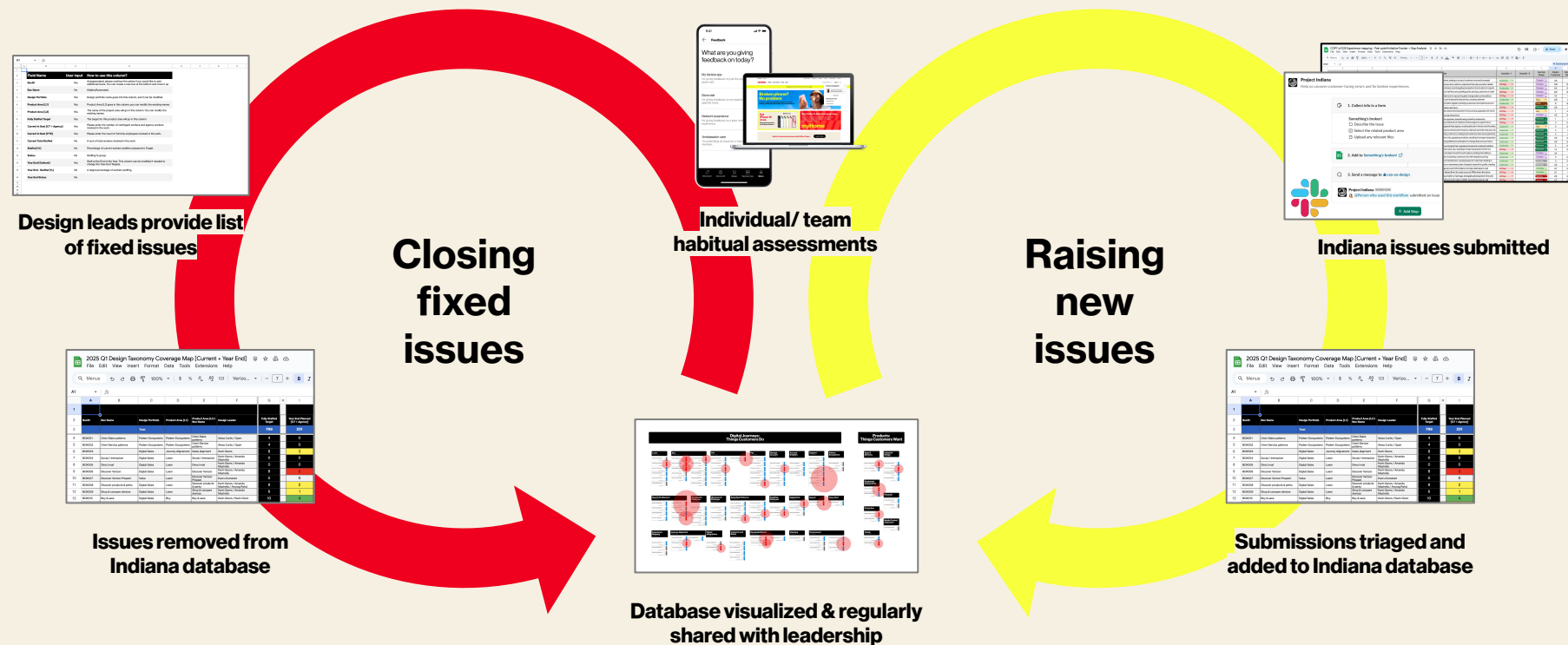
We'll work with you to filter the known issues to ensure they fit the “Indiana issue” criteria, and set up a workflow to ensure you don't have to duplicate any of your efforts.

“Should I be raising issues that are already being addressed/ on the roadmap to fix?”

Yes - we want to create visibility into the current state of our experiences and that these issues exist.

Once the issue is fixed, **we expect design leads to note that as an update to the Indiana leads.**
(see next slide for workflow)

Project Indiana workflow



Still have questions?

Please feel free to reach out to:



Julie Doten

**Experience Design Program Lead/
Project Indiana Lead**

[Email](#) / [Slack](#)

verizon

Past statuses

Status as of July 14

Key next steps

- Set up time with Alexa, Karin, John, and Caroline to review materials from Maneesha's team
- Check in with Pilot teams w/o 8/11

Track	Progress	Target	Next step
Identify leads against design taxonomy boxes	80% complete	End of June	Share assessment guidance w/ Alexa, before engaging Digital Channels leads
Ingest & link existing spreadsheets from leads	In progress where this exists	Late July for pilot teams	Continue working with design leads (see slide 10)
Set up Slack workflow for others to raise issues to leads	Piloting w/ XA team		Draft process flow for how submitted issues would flow to design leads for consideration Discuss setting up Indiana Slack channel for help/guidance
Pilot teams use Unity Heuristic assessment materials	Kicking off w/o 7/14		Kickoff w/ pilot teams to review materials and timeline
Issues submitted by pilot teams	To do	Early Sept	
Align w/ Victoria Sosik how to integrate CMI insights	In progress	August	Had an initial discussion - will follow-up after the pilot
VO of Indiana Dashboard	To do	September	Initial draft of dashboard with pilot teams.

Status as of June 12

Key next steps

- **Unity team** to share out Level 1 assessment guidance to Touchpoint teams
- **Julie** to draft guidance on how to streamline assessments into teams' existing workflows

Track	Progress	Target	Next step
Identify leads against design taxonomy boxes	80% complete	End of June	Share assessment guidance w/ Alexa, before engaging Digital Channels leads
Ingest & link existing spreadsheets from leads	In progress where this exists	Mid-July	Continue working with design leads (see slide 10)
Set up Slack workflow for others to raise issues to leads	Piloting w/ XA team	Late July	Draft process flow for how submitted issues would flow to design leads for consideration Discuss setting up Indiana Slack channel for help/ guidance
CXD teams assess live experiences	To do		Unity team drafting guidance for "Level 1" assessments
Issues submitted by leads	To do		
VO of Indiana Dashboard	To do	Late August	Initial draft of dashboard with any teams' data available at that time.

Project Indiana: Status - May 28

Project-level next steps

- Share out and align on updated severity language & assessment criteria
- **Unity team** to draft Level 1 assessment guidance for Touchpoint teams
- **Unity team** to share latest on Quality work w/ Richard
 - **Julie & Maneesha** will align on overlap
- **Julie** to draft guidance on how to streamline assessments into teams' existing workflows

Category	Kickoff w/ leads	Next step
Digital - Sales	To do	1. Draft assessment & persona guidance 2. Confirm leads w/ Alexa
Digital - Service	To do	
Digital - Conversations	To do	
Retail	Scheduled 6/3	Working w/ Naureen for data
Rep/ Assisted Channels	Scheduled 6/3	Working w/ Naureen for data
Products - Home Equipment	Complete	Follow up w/ Nitish & Andy
Products - Home app	Complete	Follow up w/ Refaeli
Products - Protect & Cloud	Complete	Follow up w/ Dawn
Products - Family app	Complete	Draft assessment guidance
Products - Mobile Products & Services	Complete	Review Martin's provided list
Products - Financial	Complete	Follow up w/ Wunmi

Graveyard

Quarterly activities

Post-Production
VQA assessments

Review existing
Indiana issues -
close all that have
been resolved

For affected areas,
reassess Indiana
issue
categorization

Submit final list of
Indiana issues

Triage and
consolidate
submitted lists

Publish updated
Indiana map

Review Design
Organization
Taxonomy and
provide any
change requests

Review change
requests and
update Design
Organization
Taxonomy with any
approved changes

Guidelines for Project Indiana issues

Severities 2-4 are considered Project Indiana issues. Level 1 issues are not.

Severity 4: Unusable/ Severe

Prevents Task Completion. The customer is not able to complete the task they've set out to accomplish.

Severity 3: Moderate

Creates significant delay and frustration. The user will probably use or attempt to use the product here, but will be severely limited in his or her ability to do so.

Severity 2: Mild

Minor effect on usability/ brand perception. The user will be able to navigate the experience in most cases, but will have to undertake some moderate effort in getting around the problem.

Severity 1: Irritant

Subtle and possible enhancements/ suggestions. The problem can be circumvented easily or is dependent on a standard that is outside the experience's boundaries.

Sources: Jeff Rubin "Handbook of Usability Testing"; Joe Dumas and Ginny Redish "A Practical Guide to Usability Testing"

Understanding the levels of defect criticality

Understanding the levels of criticality will help you determine how to triage the defects.

The frequency of occurrences will impact the level of criticality. For example, one type style defect may be a medium level criticality, where as identifying multiple occurrences will move the defect up to a high level criticality.

Criticality	Description
Low	Content-specific issues that minimally impact visual quality.
Medium	Noticeable deviations from the original design that affect the overall appearance.
High	Significant errors that severely impact visual quality, such as typos, clear text errors, or major visual deviations from the design.
Critical	Severe issues that compromise professionalism and brand representation. These need to be addressed before the next release, as they undermine the overall quality and visual integrity of the product.

Blocker is no longer in the criticality selection dropdown in Jira.

Blocker and launchgater are labels manually added on a userstory to stop a release.

Assessment Levels for reporting

Why is this important?

- Understanding the “level” will help us have a better idea of the confidence level in the number of issues being reported.

What are the assessment levels?

Level 1: <1 hour per design taxonomy box

Level 2: 1-4 hours per design taxonomy box

Level 3: 4+ hours per design taxonomy box

Note: these are hours total - so if 4 people all review an experience for 30 minutes, that would translate to 2 total hours (level 2)

Indiana x Heuristic Assessment Pilot as of July 17

We are here

★ 8/13 - Release

July			August				September		
7/14 - 7/18	7/21 - 7/25	7/28 - 8/01	8/04 - 8/08	8/11 - 8/15	8/18 - 8/22	8/25 - 8/29	9/01 - 9/05	09/08 - 9/12	9/15 - 9/19

★ Pilot kickoff

★ Progress Check-in

★ Pilot target end date

Pilot teams attempt heuristic assessment using provided materials and guidelines

1:1 sessions with Unity x Pilot teams to review work, provide feedback

Office Hours as requested

Pilot teams provide:

- WIP spreadsheet of identified issues
- Any feedback thus far

Pilot teams provide:

- Spreadsheet of identified issues
- Completed feedback

Status as of July 17

Latest

- Kicked off the Project Indiana x DU Heuristic Assessment pilot ([see deck here](#)) with Home and Family teams

Key next steps

- Meet with ID team to discuss heuristic principles for hardware products
- Meeting scheduled for 8/5 with Alexa, Karin, John, and Caroline to review test accounts available and identify any gaps
- Check in with Pilot teams w/o 8/11

Track	Progress	Target	Next step
Identify leads against design taxonomy boxes	80% complete	End of June	Align on gathered materials and resources w/ Alexa, before engaging Digital Channels leads
Ingest & link existing spreadsheets from leads	In progress where this exists	Late July for pilot teams	Continue working with design leads (see slide 10)
Set up Slack workflow for others to raise issues to leads	Piloting w/ XA team		Draft process flow for how submitted issues would flow to design leads for consideration Discuss setting up Indiana Slack channel for help/guidance
Pilot teams use Unity Heuristic assessment materials	In progress		Kicked off w/ pilot teams to review materials and timeline Set up Slack channel to gather feedback
Issues submitted by pilot teams	In progress	Early Sept	
Align w/ Victoria Sosik how to integrate CMI insights	In progress	August	Had an initial discussion - will follow-up after the pilot
VO of Indiana Dashboard	To do	September	Initial draft of dashboard with pilot teams.

Work with design leads as of September 23

Portfolio	Identified Design leads	CMI Partner/ Point of contact	Indiana Kickoff	Unity Intro	Timing of V1	Assessment	Next step
Digital Unity	Various	Barbie Casasus	Done	n/a		In progress	
Digital - Sales	Various	Brian Cave	In progress	Done		To do	
Digital - Service	Various	Amanda Kass	In progress	Done		To do	
Digital - Conversations	Various	Amanda Kass	In progress	Done		To do	
Retail	Naureen Saira	Barbie Casasus	Done	Done		In progress	Working w/ Naureen for data Pick one or two boxes to start - customer facing (vs. reps)
Call centers & Field Reps	Naveen Ir, Shuchi Singh, Aravindan Mahendran	Naren Sridhar	Done	Done		Needs attn.	Spoke w/ Naveen and Shuchi on 6/16 - major bandwidth concerns; Need to talk to Aravindan about Field Reps
Products - Home Equipment	Nitish Wakalkar, Andy Toth, Jon Simmons, Jeremy Frank	Kat de Haan	Done	Done		In review	Pilot in progress Following up to discuss heuristic principles for hardware products
Products - Home app	Refaeli Ma	Brian Cave	Done	Done		In progress	Pilot in progress
Products - Protect	Dawn Morris	Nicole Schink	Done	To do		To do	Need to regroup w/ Dawn on timing
Products - Cloud	Dawn Morris, Matt Edgar	Nicole Schink	Done	To do	Early 2026?	V0 in progress	Project Fusion launching late 2025; working with team on a placeholder (V0)
Products - Family app	Paul Lafata	Lauren Guldán	Done	Done		To do	Meeting with design leads on 7/24 to share out materials Potential bandwidth concerns when it comes to post-assessment tracking & follow-ups
Products - Mobile Products & Services	Martin Abbott	Brian Cave	Done	To do		V0 in progress	Following up w/ Martin

Open items as of July 17

Open item	Owner	Timing/ Due Date	Next step
Alignment needed: Updates to Design Organization Taxonomy to ensure latest updates will be considered	Julie	TBD	Speaking to Lindsay and others on 7/28 to confirm a target date
Question: How best to collect end-user feedback from call centers?			Discuss bandwidth concerns from this team

Closed items as of July 17

Open item	Owner	Closed	Notes
Alignment needed: Retail leads will not be accountable for Project Indiana as Naureen's work is directly responsible for this.	Julie	6/19	Confirmed with Richard in 6/19 status meeting.
Question: Who should the -5 teams to pilot the Indiana x Unity approach?		6/19	Discussed in 6/19 meeting
Open need: Considerations/ proposal for how Indiana issues would be raised in BAU prioritization processes, accepted by product partners, and logged in Jira. <i>(Request from PK)</i>	Julie	9/23	Not in scope for Indiana
Open need: Align on a way to integrate CMI insights into Indiana issue lists	Julie	9/23	Aligned with Victoria (outlined here: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1hfrWn1EIMMeBybyxW8nPLQ0GsvJMb_XyHYGdMVpzgA8/edit?tab=t.0#heading=h.iOpznq25zob)